

She waited until everyone else had left the room before approaching me.

As if what she had to say couldn't survive being heard by someone else.

She didn't speak right away.

She hesitated – the kind that lasts longer than silence but never quite becomes speech.

Then she said: "I think I need to stop coming."

I said nothing.

She stood there. Waiting for... what? Permission to leave? Permission to exist without this?

I finally asked, "Then why are you still here?"

She looked down. Said, "I don't know."

But I do.

Because people like her don't really leave.

They just hope to be noticed when they disappear.

She didn't stop coming.

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